DDD-P-56D
October 4, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. DDD-P-56C
January 27, 1970
(See 6.7)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

# PAD, MATTRESS, POLYESTER BATTING, QUILTED, WHITE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for a quilted polyester batting mattress pad.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and sizes. Mattress pads covered by this specification shall be of one type and two sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Size 1 - 36 x 75 inches.
Size 2 - 52 x 75 inches.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| V-T-285 | - | Thread, Polyester. |
| CCC-C-430 | - | Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton, and Polyester and Cotton. |
| DDD-L-20 | - | Label; For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use). |
| PPP-B-636 | - | Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard. |

Federal Standards:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| FED-STD-123 | - | Marking for Domestic Shipment (civil agencies). |
| FED-STD-751 | - | Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings. |



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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-B-41826 - Batting, Synthetic Fibers: Polyester, (Quilted and Unquilted).

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads For 40" x 48" Pallets.

(Copies of specifications, standards and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

(Copies may be obtained without charge from the Federal Trade Commission, Washington, DC 20580.)

U.S. Postal Service Manual

(Copies of the manual may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)



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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Consumer Product Safety Commission

FF-4-72 - Flammability Standard For Mattresses

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Consumer Product Safety Commission, 7315 Wisconsin Ave. (East Tower) Bethesda, MD 20207.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Guide samples of the end item, when furnished are solely for guidance and information to the supplier (see 6.3). Variation from this specification may appear in the sample in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the supplier shall furnish a sample for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3 and 6.4).

3.3 Flammability. All mattress pads shall meet the provisions of the Consumer Product Safety Commission Mattress Flammability Standard FF-4-72 when tested as specified in 4.6.



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3.4 Material.

3.4.1 Cloth. The cloth for the cover of the mattress pad shall be seamless, bleached white, polyester/cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 2, style F, or as an alternate seamless, bleached white cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 2, style B of CCC-C-430. The bias cut binding shall be made from the same cloth.

3.4.2 Polyester batting. Polyester batting conforming to type III batting of MIL-B-41826 may be used as the filler material except that the thickness shall be not greater than 0.52-inch; and the requirements for thickness after laundering, compressional recovery after laundering, and launderability shall not apply. The bonded polyester batting shall be furnished without any cloth outer covering. The use of commercial bonded polyester batting is acceptable provided that the batting possesses a minimum weight of 3.6 ounces per square yard, a maximum thickness of 0.52-inch, and the batting is bonded with an approved durable bonding agent (see 6.6) uniformly applied. Testing for thickness and weight shall be as specified in MIL-B-41826. The maximum concentration of the applied bonding agent shall not exceed 18.0 percent of the weight of the finished bonded batting. The bonding agent shall be applied to both sides of the batting filler.

3.4.3 Thread, polyester. The polyester thread shall conform to type I or II, size A, class 1, sub-class A of V-T-285.

3.5 Size. The mattress pads shall measure not less than 36 inches in width and 75 inches in length for size 1, and 52 inches in width and 75 inches in length for size 2 when examined for dimensions as specified in 4.5.2.2. A plus or minus tolerance of inch is allowed on the length and width of each size mattress pad.

3.6 Construction.

3.6.1 Stitches, seams, and stitching. Stitches, seams and stitching types, as specified in table I, shall conform to FED-STD-751.

3.6.2 Type 301 stitching. On all stitching, thread breaks and two or more consecutive skipped stitches or run-offs shall be overstitched not less than 1 inch back of the break. Ends of stitching shall be backstitched or backtacked not less than 1/2 inch except where ends are caught in other seams and stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be imbedded in the materials sewed.



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3.6.2.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during sewing, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1 inch back of the end of stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks, or two or more consecutive skipped stitches or run-offs noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1 inch in back of the defective area and continue 2 minimum of 1 inch beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching, without damaging the material, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.6.2.2 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a length of not more than 1/4 inch.

3.6.3 Stitches per inch. The minimum and maximum number of stitches per inch shall be as specified in table I.

3.6.4 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.5.2.1 shall be removed from production and replaced with non-defective material.

3.7 Manufacturing operations requirements. The mattress pads shall be manufactured in accordance with all operations specified in table I. The supplier is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations.



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TABLE I

| NO. | MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS | STITCH TYPE | SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE | STITCHES PER INCH | THREAD | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | NEEDLE | BOBBIN or LOOPER |
| 1. | Cutting. | | | | | |
| | a. The cover shall be cut with no piecing seams on either face. | | | | | |
| | b. The binding shall be cut on the bias, not less than 1-9/16 inches wide. | | | | | |
| | c. The polyester batting shall be trimmed on all four sides. | | | | | |
| 2. | Quilting. | | | | | |
| | a. Position polyester batting padding between two cover pieces. | | | | | |
| | b. Quilting shall be accomplished with either zig-zag or criss-cross (diamond) stitching as specified below. | 301 | - | 5-9 | A | A |
| | (1) Zig-zag. The horizontal distance between the parallel rows of stitches shall be 1 ± 1/16 inch. The length of the row of stitches in each direction before changing direction shall be 1-7/8 ± 1/8 inches (see figure 1 (A)). | | | | | |
| | (2) Criss-cross (diamond). The distance between the horizontal points shall be 2 ± 1/8 inches and the distance between the vertical points shall be 3-1/8 ± 1/8 inches; i.e.: the diamond shaped by criss-cross stitching shall measure 2 ± 1/8 inches parallel to the filling direction of the cloth and 3-1/8 ± 1/8 inches in the warp direction of the cloth. The stitching forming the sides of the diamond shall be 1-7/8 ± 1/8 inches (see figure 1 (B)). | | | | | |





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| NO. | MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS<br>TABLE I (cont'd) | STITCH TYPE | SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE | STITCHES PER INCH | THREAD | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | NEEDLE | BOBBIN or LOOPER |
| 3. | Binding. | | | | | |
| | a. Bind the edges of the mattress pad with a continuous binding with the raw edges of the binding turned under and stitched 1/8 ± 1/16 inch from turned edge catching all raw edges in the stitching. The binding shall begin on the short side at a corner and continue around pad finishing not less than 6 inches beyond the starting end on the short side of pad. | 301 | BSc-1 | 6-10 | A | A |
| | b. The labels shall be centered, positioned adjacent to each other on one end of the pad with the top or bottom edges caught in the binding seam. | 301 | BSc-1 | 6-10 | A | A |
| 4. | Cleanness. | | | | | |
| | a. Remove all spots and stains. | | | | | |
| | b. Trim all loose thread ends. | | | | | |





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3.7.1 Figure 1. Figure 1 is furnished for information purposes only. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written specification and the figure, the written specification shall govern.

3.8 Labels. Each mattress pad shall have an identification label and a state label attached to one end of the pad.

3.8.1 Identification label. The identification label shall conform to type I, class 5 of DDD-L-20 except that the legend and size of characters shall be as specified below:

| Legend | Size of character (minimum, inch) |
|---|---|
| Nomenclature | 1/8 |
| Contract number | 3/32 |
| Stock number | 3/32 |
| Textile Fiber Products Identification Act information | 3/32 |
| Lot Identification Number (Flammability) | 3/32 |

3.8.2 State label. The state label shall conform to the legal requirements of the state in which the mattress pads are manufactured.

3.8.3 Medical label. When specified (see 6.2) mattress pads procured for medical activities shall have a label conforming to type I, class 9 of DDD-L-20. In addition, the legend contents specified in 3.8.1, medical activities labels shall also contain the following information:

| Legend | Size of character (minimum, inch) |
|---|---|
| Manufacturer's name or registered trademark | 3/32 |
| FSN | 3/32 |
| Item identification | 3/32 |

3.9 Workmanship. The mattress pad shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels (AQLs).



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## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. When certificates of compliance, are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When required (see 6.2), the preproduction sample submitted in accordance with 3.2 shall be visually inspected as specified in 4.5.2.1 and 4.5.2.2 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship and dimensional requirements. In addition a supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance indicating conformance with all provisions of FF-4-72 Flammability Standard for Mattresses. Certification shall include material details used to meet the standard.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.5 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents. In addition when commercial polyester batting is used as filler materials for the pads, a supplier's certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirements listed below:



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| Component | Requirement paragraph |
|---|---|
| Commercial bonded polyester batting | |
| Weight | 3.4.2 |
| Thickness | 3.4.2 |
| Approved bonding agent | 3.4.2 |
| Concentration of bonding agent | 3.4.2 |

Upon request the certificate of compliance shall be accompanied by actual test, inspection or other verifiable data.

4.5.1 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operations or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance.

4.5.2 Examination of the end item. Defects found during this examination shall be classified in accordance with the lists shown in 4.5.2.1 and 4.5.2.2. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one finished mattress pad. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one finished mattress pad. The inspection levels and AQLs for these examinations shall be in accordance with 4.5.2.3.

4.5.2.1 Visual examination. The finished mattress pad shall be visually examined for defects listed in table II.

TABLE II. Classification of defects

| Examine | Defect | Classification Major | Minor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cloth defects (sheeting) | Any hole, cut, tear, mend, burn or weak place. | X | |
| | Objectionable or rancid odor. | X | |
| | Cloth not as specified. | X | |
| | Three or more contiguous broken or missing warp or filling threads. | X | |
| | Two contiguous broken or missing warp or filling threads. | | X |
| | Loose or weakening slub. | | X |
| Cleanness | Any spot or stain, more than 1/4 inch square in area, clearly noticeable at a distance of 6 feet. | | X |



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TABLE II. Classification of defects (cont'd)

| Examine | Defect | Classification Major | Minor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cover | Contains piecing seams on either face. | X | |
| Quilting | Any thin place devoid of padding 2 inches square or more in area. | X | |
| | Any thin place devoid of padding, more than 1 inch square in area, but less than 2 inches square in area. | | X |
| | Three or more thin places devoid of padding regardless of area. | X | |
| | Any furrow, lump or bulge resulting from uneven or improper distribution of the padding. | X | |
| | Four or more untrimmed thread ends or loose threads, 1/4 inch or more in length. | | X |
| | Surface twisted, pleated, wavy or puckered. | X | |
| | Three or more pleats less than 8 inches in length and 1/4 inch or more in depth at widest point regardless of area per pad. | | X |
| | Any pleat regardless of area, 8 inches or more in length and 1/4 inch or more in depth at widest point, or any pleat not within 5 inches from any edge extending more than 2 inches in length. | X | |
| | Needle chew. | X | |
| | A run back of more than 1-1/2 inches of broken or missing stitches in the quilting. | | X |
| | Any area evidencing complete bobbin change. | | X |
| | One or more rows of stitching omitted in quilting. | X | |
| | Stitches per inch: | | |
| | Two or more stitches less than the number specified. | X | |
| | One stitch more or less than the number specified. | | X |



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TABLE II. Classification of defects (cont'd)

| Examine | Defect | Classification Major | Classification Minor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Binding | Not cut in bias direction. | X | |
| | Width not as specified. 1/ | X | |
| | Torn or chewed. | X | |
| | Not one continuous length per pad. | | X |
| | Closing end extends less than 6 inches beyond the starting end. | | X |
| Seams and stitching | Binding not seamed with seam type BSc-1. | | X |
| | Not stitch type 301 throughout. | | X |
| | Stitching margin of binding less than 1/16 inch or more than 3/16 inch. | | X |
| | Binding seam does not begin at corner on short side of pad. | | X |
| | Binding sewn with less than 6 stitches per inch. | | X |
| | Binding sewn with more than 10 stitches per inch. | | X |
| | Any open seam or run-off more than 1 inch in length. | X | |
| | Any open seam or run-off 1 inch or less in length. | | X |
| | NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken, or when two or more consecutive skipped stitches or run-offs occur. | | |
| | Edge of pad not securely caught in binding. | | X |
| | Edge of pad not fully inserted into binding after stitching. | | X |
| | Any raw edge of binding more than 1/2 inch in length. | | X |

1/ May be determined prior to stitching.



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TABLE II. Classification of defects (cont'd)

| Examine | Defect | Classification Major | Minor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Seams and stitching (cont'd) | Three or more raw edges of binding per pad up to and including 1/2 inch in length. | | X |
| | Raw edge of pad covering, over 2 inches in length. | | X |
| | Two or more raw edges of pad covering, up to and including 2 inches in length. | | X |
| | Any raw edge of the pad covering regardless of length, not caught in binding stitching. | X | |
| | NOTE: This examination will be made by turning back the edge of the binding at the raw edge locale and determining visually whether the pad covering is caught in the binding stitches. | | |
| | Stitch tension loose, resulting in a loosely secured seam or looped stitches. | | X |
| | Stitch tension tight, stitches break when normal strain is applied to the seam or stitching. | | X |
| | NOTE: Puckering is evidence of tight tension. | | |
| Quilting stitching | More than 1-1/2 inches of broken or missing stitches in quilting. | X | |
| All other stitching | 1/2 inch or less of broken or missing stitching. | | X |
| | More than 1/2 inch of broken or missing stitching. | X | |
| Stitching ends | Ends of stitching not secured as specified (except when caught in other seams or stitching). | | X |



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TABLE II. Classification of defects (cont'd)

| Examine | Defect | Classification Major | Minor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Thread breaks, skipped stitches or runoffs (unless otherwise classified herein) | Overstitched less than one inch in each direction beyond the defective stitching area. | | X |
| | NOTE: Thread breaks, two or more consecutive skipped stitches or runoffs not overstitched shall be classified as open seams. | | |
| | Quilting dimensions not in accordance with table I. | | X |
| Labels | Missing, misplaced or incomplete, incorrect, or illegible. | X | |

4.5.2.2 Examination for dimensions. Each mattress pad examined for dimensions, shall be laid in a flat position without tension. The length and width shall be the average of three measurements taken in each direction. Any average less or more than the length or width specified (including permitted tolerances) for the size required in 3.5, shall be classified as a defect.

4.5.2.3 Inspection level and AQL. The inspection level and the acceptable quality level (AQL) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

| Examination | Inspection level | AQL Major | AQL Total (major & minor) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 4.5.2.1 | II | 4.0 | 10.0 |
| 4.5.2.2 | S-3 | | 4.0 (1 class) |



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4.5.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.

4.5.3.1 Examination for packaging, packing and marking. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking complies with section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery except that it need not be closed. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for defects of closure. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

| Examine | Defect |
|---|---|
| Marking (exterior and interior) | Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application. |
| Materials | Any component missing, damaged or not as specified. |
| Workmanship | Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flap, improper taping, loose strapping, inadequate stapling.<br>Bulged or distorted container.<br>Polyethylene bag heat sealed seam open, noncontinuous or crooked; vent holes missing or greater than 1/4 inch diameter.<br>Incorrectly fabricated bag.<br>Alternate polyethylene bag not provided with tuck or reverse flap. |
| Content | Number of polyethylene bagged packages per shipping container is more or less than required. |

4.5.3.2 Examination for palletization. An examination shall be made to determine that palletization complies with section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.



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| Examine | Defect |
|---|---|
| Finished dimensions | Length, width or height exceeds specified maximum requirement. |
| Palletization | Not as specified.<br>Pallet pattern not as specified.<br>Interlocking of loads not as specified.<br>Load not bonded with required straps as specified. |
| Weight | Exceeds maximum load limits. |
| Marking | Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application. |

4.6 Flammability. Flammability tests shall be performed in accordance with all the provisions of the Consumer Product Safety Commission Flammability Standard for Mattresses FF-4-72. A suppliers certificate of compliance shall be furnished and will be accepted for the stated requirements. Certification shall include material details used to meet the standard.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pad shall be neatly folded to measure approximately 18 by 25 inches. The folded pad shall then be packaged in a close-fitting flat or square style clear polyethylene film bag of 0.00125 inch thickness (± 20 percent tolerance). The bag may be fabricated from polyethylene film tubing or sheeting. The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight, continuous, and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. A 1/4 inch maximum diameter hole shall be made at any two corners of each polyethylene bag to allow the excess air to escape. The bag shall be closed by means of a heat seal or pressure-sensitive tape. Closure shall be made as close as possible to the open end. Prior to or during the closure operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled. As an alternate the polyethylene bag may be of the tuck in or reverse flap type, in which a heat seal closure and corner vent hole are not required.



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5.1.2 Level C (commercial packaging). Each pad shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The package and the quantity per package shall be the same as that used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Eighteen size 1 or twelve size 2 pads, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style OSC-L (minimum 3-inch overlap), grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each fiberboard container shall be fitted with a taped liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat, eighteen size 1 or twelve size 2 in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 25-1/2 inches in length, 18-1/2 inches in width, and 27 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Eighteen size 1 or twelve size 2 pads, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style OSC-L (minimum 3-inch overlap), type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat, eighteen size 1 or twelve size 2 in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 25-1/2 inches in length, 18-1/2 inches in width, and 27 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C (commercial packing). Pads, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with the U.S. Postal Service Manual, Uniform Freight Classification Rules, or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.



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5.3 Palletization (military requirements only). When specified (see 6.2), pads packed as specified in 5.2 shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.4.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.2.1 Polyethylene bagged packages. Polyethylene bagged packages shall have the required identification information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The mattress pads are intended for use on beds for the protection of mattresses by military and nonmilitary agencies.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired option offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When a first article sample is required (see 3.2, 4.3 and 6.4).
(c) Size required (see 1.2.1).
(d) When medical label is required (see 3.8.3).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(g) When palletization is required (see 5.3).



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6.3 Sample. For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of one finished mattress pad. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.5 When level B packaging requirements are specified for civil agency procurements, the requirements in 5.1.1 shall apply.

6.6 Bonding agents. Approval of bonding agents for use in battings covered by this specification is the responsibility of the U.S. Army Natick Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760. Approval is based on more extensive evaluations, including those of toxicity, which are not set forth in the specification. Because of the time necessary to conduct full evaluation, only those bonding agents already approved and so listed in the invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be considered acceptable for the related procurement.

6.6.1 Submittal for approval. Request for approval should be submitted to the U.S. Army Natick Laboratories, attention of STSNL-VT. It should be accompanied by approximately five square yards of a minimum of 2 ounces per square yard polyester batting manufactured with the proposed bonding agent together with applicable test data. Information is to be furnished regarding the commercial designation and chemical description of the bonding agent. (Approved lists will indicate only the commercial designation). Chemical identification with products already approved should be made, if applicable, and any available data on skin irritancy or toxicity should be submitted. If applicable, a statement should be included that as used the resin is well cured and that no materials with known high toxicity are used prior to cure.

6.7 Supersession data. This specification includes the requirements of Interim Purchase Description S-7-73 dated 15 June 1973.



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Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 82

Review activity:

Army - MD

User activities:

Navy - MS, MC

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

AGR
COM-NBS
DC
GSA-FSS
HEW
INT
JUS-FPI
VA-DMS

Project No. 7210-0156



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